

Use Financial Mathematics in Realistic Planning

Use numbers, calculations and reasoning to make and carry out a plan.

★ Today I am learning to use financial mathematics in realistic planning.

Step 11

Lower Elementary
(Grades 3–4)

1. Plan a Party

You are planning a birthday party for 10 friends.

Look at the items and prices below.

					
Pizza	Drinks	Chips	Cake	Decorations	Party bags
\$18.00	\$6.00	\$4.00	\$15.00	\$8.00	\$10.00

Choose the items you will buy. Make sure you do not spend more than \$60.

My Choices		
Item	Price (\$)	Yes / No

My Calculations	

Total I will spend: \$ _____

Money left over: \$ _____

2. Compare and Choose

You want to buy a new backpack.

Compare the three options.

Which one gives the best value for money?

Show your thinking.

Option A	Option B	Option C
		
Price: \$45 20% off	Price: \$40 15% off	Price: \$38 Free water bottle

Best value: ☐ Option A ☐ Option B ☐ Option C

Why? _____

3. Weekly Budget

You get \$35 pocket money for the week.

Plan how you will spend it.

Item	Planned (\$)	Actual (\$)	Difference (\$)
Saving 			
Snacks 			
Games 			
Transport 			
Other 			
Total			

Think and Answer

a) Did you spend more or less than \$35?

b) How much did you save?
\$ _____

c) What will you do with the difference?

4. Savings Plan

You want to buy a tablet that costs \$240.

You can save a fixed amount each week.

Complete the table to see how long it will take.



Save Each Week (\$)	Number of Weeks	Total Saved (\$)	Goal Reached? (Yes / No)
\$10			
\$15			
\$20			
\$30			
\$40			

Which savings plan will help you reach your goal the fastest? _____

How do you know? _____

5. Real-Life Scenario

Read the situation. Answer the questions.

The Carter family is planning a weekend trip. They need to budget for fuel, accommodation, food and activities. They have \$500 to spend.



Estimated Costs	Cost (\$)
Fuel	\$120
Accommodation (1 night)	\$180
Food	\$130
Activities	\$90
Total	

Questions

a) What is the total estimated cost?
\$ _____

b) Will \$500 be enough?
☐ Yes ☐ No

c) How much money will be left over or needed?
\$ _____

d) What could the family do to save money?

6. Plan for the Future

Choose a goal and make a 4-week plan to reach it.

Show how you will save and any costs you will need to consider.

Goal: ☐ New bike (\$180) ☐ Concert tickets (\$160) ☐ Sports shoes (\$120)

Other: _____ Cost: \$ _____

Week	Money I Save (\$)	Other Money (e.g. birthday) (\$)	Total Saved So Far (\$)	Costs I Need to Pay (\$)	Total After Costs (\$)
1					
2					
3					
4					

Will you reach your goal after 4 weeks? ☐ Yes ☐ No

What could you do if you do not reach your goal? _____

My Learning Check

Circle how confident you feel.



I understand this well.



I need more practice.



I need help.

I used...



calculations

☐


tables

☐


percentages

☐


money skills

☐

Today I learned...

One thing I did well: _____

One thing I will improve: _____



Think About It!

Why is it important to plan carefully with money?

